

Benjamin Thompson

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Front-End Software Engineer – UI/UX, Architecture, Design Systems, AI-Assisted Development

Front-End Software Engineer with 20+ years of experience architecting accessible enterprise web applications, component systems, and modern UI platforms. Specializes in turning fragmented or stalled products into maintainable, scalable applications by establishing strong front-end architecture, design systems, and developer workflows. Known for combining engineering rigor with UX design expertise while integrating AI-assisted development practices that accelerate delivery without sacrificing accessibility, quality, or maintainability.

Professional Experience

Lead UI Developer

July 2025 - Apr 2026

Trustwave / LevelBlue, Dallas, TX (contract)

Embedded on a three-person strike team tasked with recovering a cybersecurity product stalled for over a year, with a mandate to ship within six months.

- Architected an opinionated Angular 21 component library (RxJS, PrimeNG, Zod-validated forms) that enforced accessibility, branding, and interaction standards by design, significantly reducing UI inconsistency.
- Designed component APIs for dual consumption by human developers and AI coding agents inside a Cursor-based multi-agent workflow, preserving WCAG accessibility and code integrity at scale.
- Implemented RBAC-driven route guards and multi-tenant access patterns validated with Vitest and Playwright, coordinating delivery through Jira, Confluence, and Figma-based design handoff.

Outcome: Delivered a stalled application within the six-month mandate, compressing feature delivery from months to weeks while maintaining enterprise-level consistency and accessibility.

Senior Software Engineer

Feb 2021 - Jan 2025

Fortra, Eden Prairie, MN

Following Fortra's acquisition of Digital Defense, transitioned into a centralized UX engineering role supporting multiple enterprise products and front-end technology stacks.

- Built the Angular counterpart to Fortra's React-based design system, serving as the sole Angular specialist and unifying UI standards across React (TanStack Query, Zustand, React Hook Form, Zod) and Angular applications.
- Led Figma-to-code implementation and greenfield feature delivery on React-based products, backed by Jest, Testing Library, Storybook, and Mock Service Worker (MSW) test coverage.
- Supported CI/CD delivery (Jenkins, GitLab CI/CD, Docker, Nx monorepo) and cross-team component reuse, reducing duplication across a multi-framework product portfolio.

Outcome: Enabled design-system adoption across multiple frameworks and teams, supporting consistent UI delivery during post-acquisition integration and product expansion.

Staff Front-End Engineer

May 2013 - Feb 2021

Digital Defense, Inc., San Antonio, TX

Joined as one of two front-end engineers responsible for rebuilding Frontline VM, a flagship SaaS vulnerability management platform, from the ground up.

- Owned UI architecture and UX design for a data-intensive security platform, building shared Angular and AngularJS component libraries (Angular Material, Bootstrap) that improved consistency across the product line.
- Led migration from AngularJS to Angular 10 while introducing improved accessibility standards including semantic HTML, stricter color contrast ratios, descriptive text, and more intuitive iconography.
- Designed and delivered AWS-backed proofs-of-concept and MVPs (Cognito, EC2, DynamoDB) with Python and RESTful APIs, expanding the team's technical capabilities beyond the core front-end stack.

Outcome: Delivered and evolved a flagship platform recognized by analysts including Gartner and Frost & Sullivan, and awarded SC Magazine "Best Buy" for usability.

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Web Designer and Developer

Nov 2010 - Apr 2013

Independent Freelance Contractor, San Antonio, TX

Delivered full-cycle web design and development for small businesses and nonprofits, from discovery and UX definition through implementation and deployment.

- Built custom WordPress themes and PHP/MySQL CMS solutions with jQuery-driven front ends, translating business needs into maintainable systems.
- Led client-facing discovery, branding, and e-commerce implementation (BigCommerce, LemonStand) for non-technical stakeholders.
- Conducted a full site audit and delivered the resulting redesign for the University of Colorado Bookstore..

Outcome: Successfully delivered end-to-end websites and CMS solutions for numerous organizations while managing all aspects of client engagement.

Lead UI and Graphic Designer

Feb 2006 - Apr 2010

MOD Systems, Seattle, WA

Sole designer for an early media-on-demand platform delivering digital content through retail kiosks, mobile devices, and set-top boxes prior to mainstream streaming.

- Designed the end-to-end user experience across kiosk, mobile, and TV platforms, including systems deployed nationally with partners such as Starbucks HEAR Music, Best Buy, Blockbuster, and Circuit City.
- Translated complex media workflows into intuitive retail and consumer experiences, and produced product concepts and investor materials that helped secure digital rights from major studios and networks.
- Directed contract designers and owned all brand, marketing, and exploratory product work, including early mobile-first digital commerce concepts.

Outcome: Served as the creative lead for a nationally deployed, multi-platform product for physical and digital distribution.

Recent Projects

CXII.us

Personal portfolio and resume platform

- Built using Svelte 5, TypeScript, and Cloudflare Workers.
- Integrated the Anthropic SDK for AI-assisted, conversational content exploration over Zod-validated structured content.
- Developed reusable component architecture using bits-ui and modern accessibility practices.

What's For Dinner

Offline-capable, recipe book and meal-planning PWA

- Built using Svelte 5, SvelteKit, Dexie, Supabase, PostgreSQL, and TypeScript.
- Implemented conversational recipe generation using the OpenAI SDK with structured Zod responses.
- Supports offline operation, cross-device synchronization, and AI-assisted editing with comprehensive testing using Vitest and Playwright.

Core Skills

Front-End Architecture | Component Libraries | Design Systems | WCAG Accessibility | AI-Assisted Development | Design-to-Code Implementation
Cross-Functional Collaboration | Team Leadership | Enterprise SaaS Delivery | Product Modernization

Languages: JavaScript | TypeScript | Semantic HTML | CSS | Sass/SCSS | JSON

Frameworks & Architecture: Angular | React | Svelte | SvelteKit | Next.js | RxJS | Web Components

UI & Design: Design Systems | TailwindCSS | Material UI | Angular Material | PrimeNG | Storybook | Figma | Responsive Design

APIs & Data: Node.js | REST | GraphQL | SQL | IndexedDB | Zod | JWT | RBAC

Tooling & Delivery: Git | Docker | Webpack | Vite | Vitest | Jest | Nx | Cloudflare Workers | CI/CD | AWS | Jenkins

Education

Associate of Science, Digital Media

Full Sail University, Winter Park, FL

2004 - 2005

- Class Valedictorian
- Advanced Achiever Award
- Certificate of Excellence

Military Experience

Boatswain's Mate 3rd Class

2008 - 2016

US Coast Guard Reserve, Everett, WA | Port O'Connor, TX